

Why Indian women deserve support, not judgement

We must start questioning the unrealistic expectations placed on women and **inculcate** a culture that promotes shared responsibilities and duties

Indian women are increasingly taking on **obligations** that exceed 55 hours per week. They manage to **pursue** their professional careers while also managing a household—what one may refer to as the “second job.” It reveals an **unsettling** fact about the **intimidating** pressure on women to perform above their capabilities. Although this problem between job and private life affects women all over the world, it is especially difficult for Indian women due to cultural expectations, **societal** standards and the long-held **conviction** that they “must do it all.”

The question arises: why is there so much pressure on Indian women to push themselves beyond their **breaking point**? The answer **lies** in deeply **ingrained** gender roles and societal expectations. While **strides** have been **made** in women’s **empowerment**, the **onus** of managing the household and caring for children **continues** to largely fall on their shoulders, even as they **excel** in their careers.

As more women enter the workforce and pursue professional goals, the **expectation** to continue fulfilling traditional roles **has** not **diminished**. Instead, it has **expanded**, creating an **unsustainable juggling act**.

Are women **taken for granted**? In many ways, yes. The **concept** that women are born to balance this act **manifests** itself in the belief that they can easily handle a high-demanding profession while also serving as primary carers, homemakers, and support for the rest of the extended family. However, such an assumption ignores the impact on their physical and mental **well-being**. Each woman’s **drive** is influenced by the societally **imposed** “superwoman” image, which puts undue pressure on them. And when they **falter**, they are unfairly judged.

But why should society judge women for trying to manage the impossible? The expectations placed on women **often** come with little **recognition** or **appreciation** for the sacrifices they make. Instead, when women struggle or choose to prioritise one **aspect** of their life over another, they are **met** with **criticism** rather than **compassion**.

This is especially true for those who lack a strong support system. If a woman does not have family members willing to share the load of **child-rearing** or household management, she is left to carry an even heavier burden. Should she be judged for this? Absolutely not.

Let us not forget that many Indian women are also teachers, a profession that requires **nurturing**, patience and a **relentless** dedication to the betterment of future generations.

These women are shaping young minds in the classroom while simultaneously caring for their own families at home. The least society can do is give them the **space** and freedom they deserve, without the weight of judgement.

It's time we, as a society, recognise that women's worth is not measured by their ability to "do it all." We must start questioning the unrealistic expectations placed on them and, instead, **advocate** for a culture that promotes shared responsibilities. Supporting **women** in their **endeavors**—whether in their careers or at home—by giving them the freedom to make choices without judgment **is** essential. Only then can we begin to **alleviate** the unnecessary pressures that have, for too long, **weighed** on the shoulders of Indian women. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

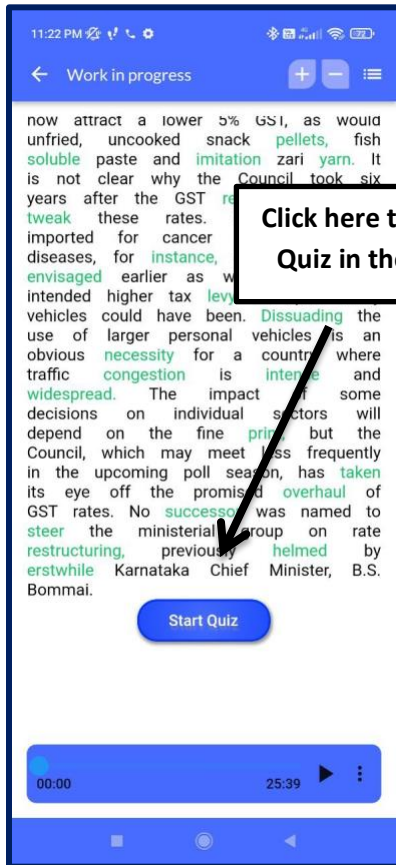
1. **Inculcate** (verb) – instill, implant, teach, educate, foster सीखाना
2. **Obligation** (noun) – duty, responsibility, commitment, requirement, necessity कर्तव्य
3. **Pursue** (verb) – follow, chase, seek, strive for, engage in अनुसरण करना
4. **Unsettling** (adjective) – disturbing, disconcerting, troubling, worrisome, alarming अशांत करने वाला
5. **Intimidating** (adjective) – daunting, frightening, menacing, threatening, overpowering धमकी भरा
6. **Societal** (adjective) – social, communal, public, collective, cultural सामाजिक
7. **Conviction** (noun) – belief, faith, assurance, certainty, confidence विश्वास
8. **Breaking point** (noun) – limit, threshold, climax, critical point, verge सहनशक्ति सीमा
9. **Lie** (verb) – exist, reside, be situated, be located, remain स्थित होना
10. **Ingrained** (adjective) – deep-rooted, embedded, established, fixed, inherent स्थापित
11. **Make a stride** (phrase) – progress, advance, move forward, improve, develop प्रगति करना
12. **Empowerment** (noun) – enablement, authorization, liberation, enfranchisement, strengthening सशक्तिकरण
13. **Onus** (noun) – burden, responsibility, duty, obligation, liability जिम्मेदारी
14. **Excel** (verb) – surpass, outshine, outdo, be superior, thrive श्रेष्ठ होना
15. **Diminish** (verb) – reduce, lessen, decrease, dwindle, decline घटाना
16. **Expand** (verb) – extend, enlarge, broaden, increase, amplify विस्तार करना
17. **Unsustainable** (adjective) – unfeasible, untenable, unmanageable, impractical, not maintainable अस्थिर
18. **Juggling act** (noun) – balancing act, multitasking, handling multiple responsibilities, managing several tasks, coordination effort संतुलन कार्य
19. **Take for granted** (phrase) – to accept or assume without question हल्के में ले लेना
20. **Manifest** (verb) – display, show, demonstrate, reveal, exhibit प्रकट करना
21. **Well-being** (noun) – welfare, health, happiness, comfort, prosperity कल्याण
22. **Drive** (noun) – motivation, ambition, determination, initiative, impetus प्रेरणा

23. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, inflict, levy, mandate, require थोपना
24. **Falter** (verb) – hesitate, waver, stumble, weaken, hesitate डगमगाना
25. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, commonly, usually, repeatedly अक्सर
26. **Recognition** (noun) – acknowledgment, appreciation, acceptance, identification, fame मान्यता
27. **Appreciation** (noun) – gratitude, recognition, acknowledgment, admiration, valuation सराहना
28. **Aspect** (noun) – facet, feature, part, element, side पहलू
29. **Meet** (verb) – satisfy, fulfill, comply with, reach, correspond to पूरा करना
30. **Criticism** (noun) – disapproval, censure, critique, fault-finding, condemnation आलोचना
31. **Compassion** (noun) – empathy, sympathy, pity, kindness, understanding दया
32. **Child-rearing** (noun) – parenting, raising children, upbringing, nurturing, care of children बच्चे का पालन-पोषण
33. **Nurture** (verb) – foster, cultivate, encourage, support, develop पालन-पोषण करना
34. **Relentless** (adjective) – persistent, unyielding, constant, incessant, unremitting दृढ़
35. **Space** (noun) – room, area, freedom, latitude, capacity स्वतंत्रता
36. **Advocate** (verb) – support, promote, champion, endorse, back समर्थन करना
37. **Endeavour** (noun) – effort, attempt, undertaking, enterprise, pursuit प्रयास
38. **Alleviate** (verb) – relieve, ease, reduce, mitigate, lessen कम करना
39. **Weigh** (on) (verb) – burden, press, oppress, affect, impact भार डालना

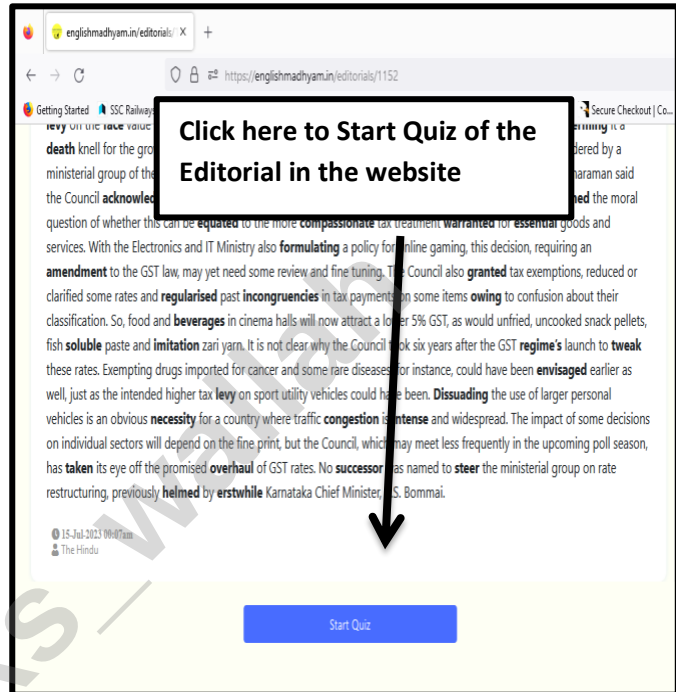
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Unrealistic Expectations:** Indian women face excessive and often unattainable societal expectations that demand they excel in both professional and domestic spheres.
2. **Long Working Hours:** Many Indian women work over 55 hours a week, balancing demanding careers with household responsibilities, akin to managing a second job.
3. **Cultural Pressure:** Deep-rooted cultural norms and societal standards intensify the pressure on women to "do it all," surpassing their natural capabilities.
4. **Gender Roles:** Traditional gender roles persist, placing the primary responsibility of household management and child-rearing on women, even as they pursue careers.
5. **Women's Empowerment vs. Expectations:** Despite advancements in women's empowerment, the expectation to maintain traditional roles alongside professional achievements remains unchanged.
6. **Unsustainable Juggling Act:** The combination of career ambitions and domestic duties creates an unsustainable situation for many women, leading to burnout and stress.
7. **Being Taken for Granted:** Society often takes women's efforts for granted, assuming they can effortlessly handle high-demand professions and extensive domestic duties simultaneously.
8. **Impact on Well-being:** The "superwoman" stereotype adversely affects women's physical and mental health, ignoring the real strain of their dual responsibilities.
9. **Judgment and Criticism:** When women struggle or prioritize one aspect of their lives over another, they face societal judgment and lack of understanding instead of support.
10. **Lack of Support Systems:** Women without strong family support systems bear even heavier burdens, yet they are still subjected to criticism rather than assistance.
11. **Role of Women Teachers:** Many Indian women are educators who dedicate themselves to shaping future generations while also managing their own families.
12. **Need for Societal Recognition:** Society must recognize and appreciate the multifaceted roles women play, providing them with the necessary space and freedom.
13. **Valuing Women's Worth:** A woman's value should not be measured by her ability to manage multiple roles but by her individual contributions and choices.
14. **Promoting Shared Responsibilities:** There is a crucial need to advocate for a culture that distributes domestic and professional responsibilities more equitably between genders.
15. **Call for Compassion and Support:** To alleviate the undue pressures on Indian women, society must offer support and understanding, allowing women to make life choices without fear of judgment.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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